“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 15

The Lord’s Paugaṇḍa Pastimes

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 “I worship Lord Caitanya: by merely offering a flower (*sumanas*) at His lotus feet, even an evil-minded person becomes good-minded.” (Hari-bhakti-vilāsa 7.1)

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 I shall now list the *sūtras* of the *paugaṇḍa* pastimes. In His *paugaṇḍa* years the Lord’s chief occupation was study.

4 The *paugaṇḍa* pastimes of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa are very extensive and enchanting: they begin with the start of His learning and end with His taking a bride’s hand.

5 He studied grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita and learned the *sūtras* and their glosses by heart on hearing them only once.

6 In a short time He became expert in the *Pañjī-ṭīkā*; though a newcomer, He outdid students of long standing.

7 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described the Lord’s pastimes of study in detail in the *Caitanya-maṅgala*.

8 One day, bowing at His mother's feet, the Lord said, "Mother, give Me one gift."

9 His mother said, "I will give whatever You ask." The Lord said, "Do not eat grains on Ekādaśī."

10 Śacī said, "I will not eat them; You have spoken well." From then on she began to observe Ekādaśī.

11 Then Miśra, seeing that Viśvarūpa had reached youth, resolved to find a bride and arrange his marriage.

12 Hearing of it, Viśvarūpa left home and fled; he took *sannyāsa* and went on pilgrimage.

13 Hearing this, Śacī and Miśra were grief-stricken, and the Lord consoled His mother and father:

14 "It is good that Viśvarūpa has taken *sannyāsa*: he has delivered both his father's family and his mother's.

15 I will serve you both." Hearing this, His father and mother were comforted.

16 One day, after chewing betel that had been offered to the Deity, the Lord fell to the ground unconscious.

17 His father and mother hastily sprinkled water on His face, and when He came to, the Lord told them an extraordinary story:

18 "Viśvarūpa took Me away from here and told Me, 'Take *sannyāsa*.'

19 I said, ‘My father and mother are helpless, and I am only a boy—what do I know of *sannyāsa*?

20 As a householder I shall serve My father and mother; that will please Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa.’

21 Then Viśvarūpa sent Me back here and asked Me to convey millions upon millions of obeisances to Mother.”

22 In this way Gaurahari performed various pastimes; why He performed them, I cannot understand.

23 After some days Miśra departed for the other world, and grief welled up in the hearts of both mother and son.

24 Friends and relatives came and consoled them both, and the Lord performed the rites for His father according to scriptural rule.

25 Some days later the Lord reflected, “I have remained a householder; now I should follow the duties of household life.

26 Without a wife, household life is not graceful.” Thinking this, He resolved to marry.

27 “It is not the house that is called the home; the wife is called the home. Together with her one attains all the goals of life.”

28 One day, by providence, as the Lord was returning from His studies, He saw Vallabhācārya’s daughter on the path to the Gaṅgā.

29 Their eternally perfect love awakened in them both, and by providence the matchmaker Vanamālī came to Śacī.

30 At a hint from Śacī he arranged the match, and the son of Śacī married Lakṣmī.

31 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this in detail. Here only the *sūtra* of the *paugaṇḍa* pastimes is set forth.

32 There are many kinds of pastimes in the *paugaṇḍa* period, and Vṛndāvana dāsa has described them in detail.

33 Therefore I have given only a glimpse of them here; through the *Caitanya-maṅgala* they have become famous among all people.

34 Hoping for the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, Kṛṣṇadāsa tells the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.